

## Eleonora Minaeva

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| CONTACT INFORMATION | <i>Mobile:</i> +39 351 519 2429<br><i>Web-page:</i> <a href="http://eleonora-minaeva.com">eleonora-minaeva.com</a><br><i>Email:</i> <a href="mailto:eleonora.minaeva@eui.eu">eleonora.minaeva@eui.eu</a>                                                                                                   |                          |
| RESEARCH INTERESTS  | Subnational Politics and Decentralization; Electoral Institutions and Accountability; Political Economy of Governance; Contentious Politics; Post-Soviet and Eurasian Politics.                                                                                                                            |                          |
| EDUCATION           | <b>European University Institute</b> , Florence, Italy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                          |
|                     | Ph.D. in Political Science                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2022–present             |
|                     | Department of Political and Social Sciences                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                          |
|                     | • Thesis: <i>Political (De)Centralization Under Authoritarianism</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |
|                     | <b>European University at St.Petersburg</b> , St. Petersburg, Russia                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |
|                     | Master of Political Science, Department of Political Science                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2018–2020                |
| ACADEMIC POSITIONS  | • Thesis: <i>Factors of Electoral Mobilization at the Local Level in Russia: 2016–2018</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                          |
|                     | • GPA: 3.95                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                          |
|                     | <b>Perm State University</b> , Perm, Russia                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                          |
|                     | Master of International Relations, Department of Political Science                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2017–2019                |
|                     | • Thesis: <i>The Influence of European Urban Practices on Coalition Interactions in the Largest Russian Cities</i>                                                                                                                                                                                         |                          |
|                     | • GPA: 4.0                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                          |
| VISITING POSITIONS  | Bachelor of Political Science, Department of Political Science                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2013–2017                |
|                     | • Thesis: <i>Ethnic Territorial Autonomies: The Problem of Political Space Segmentation</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                          |
|                     | • GPA: 3.96                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                          |
|                     | <b>European University Institute</b> , Florence, Italy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                          |
| PUBLICATIONS        | PhD Researcher, Department of Political and Social Sciences                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2022–present             |
|                     | <b>Center for Comparative History and Political Studies</b> , Russia                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |
| PUBLICATIONS        | Research Fellow                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | September 2020–June 2022 |
|                     | <b>Institute for European, Russian and Eurasian Studies (IERES)</b> , George Washington University, Washington DC, USA                                                                                                                                                                                     |                          |
| PUBLICATIONS        | Visiting Scholar                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | January 2025–May 2025    |
|                     | [1] Serebrennikov D., Minaeva E., Ross S. (2026) Surveillance as Governance: Policing Effectiveness and Political Control in the Moscow AI Experiment. <i>Forthcoming in Russian Politics</i> .                                                                                                            |                          |
| PUBLICATIONS        | [2] Kostelka F., Alberdi M., Bradley M., Fiselier T., Jabbour A., Mansour N., Minaeva E., Porciuleanu S., Rafailova D. (2026) Mass Attitudes towards Russia's Aggression against Ukraine: Tentative Support for Top-Down Opinion Formation. <i>Forthcoming in European Journal of Political Research</i> . |                          |

- [3] Bederson V., Minaeva E. (2024) “We’ll Find a Way to Settle This Among Ourselves”: Conditions for the Centralization of Municipal Powers in Urban Development. *Russian Sociological Review*, Vol. 23, Issue 2: 67–89. DOI: 10.17323/1728-192x-2024-2-67-89. (in Russian)
- [4] Semenov A., Minaeva E. (2024) Mobilizational Momentum and Electoral Results of "Party in Power". *Politeia*, Vol. 1 (112), 77-97. DOI: 10.30570/2078-5089-2024-112-1-77-97. (in Russian)
- [5] Minaeva E., Rumiantseva A., Zavadskaya M. (2023) From local elections to appointments: How has municipal reform changed vote delivery in Russian municipalities? *Electoral Studies*, Vol. 85, DOI:10.1016/j.electstud.2023.102657.
- [6] Minaeva E. (2023) Policy Activism in Urban Governance: The Case of Master Plan Development in Perm. in Jeremy Morris, Andrei Semenov and Regina Smyth (Ed.) *Varieties of Russian Activism: State-Society Contestation in Everyday Life*. **Bloomington: Indiana University Press**.
- [7] Minaeva E., Panov P. (2023) Dense Networks, Ethnic Minorities, and Electoral Mobilization in Contemporary Russia. *Problems of Post-Communism*, DOI:10.1080/10758216.2021.1974885.
- [8] Minaeva E. (2022) Strategies for the Preservation and Cancellation of the Direct Election of Municipal Heads in Russia. *Universe of Russia. Sociology. Ethnology*, Vol. 31, Issue 2: 97-117. (in Russian)
- [9] Bederson V, Zhelnina A, Zaporozhets O, Minaeva E, Semenov A, Tykanova E, Khokhlova A, Chernysheva A, Shevtsova I. (2021). *Cities of Diverging Streets: Trajectories of Urban Conflicts in Russia*. Monograph. Moscow; Saint Petersburg: Federal Center of Theoretical and Applied Sociology of the Russian Academy of Sciences.
- [10] Minaeva E., Panov P. (2020) Localization of Ethnic Groups in the Regions as a Factor of Cross-Regional Variations in Voting for United Russia. *Russian Politics*: 131-153.
- [11] Minaeva E., Semenov A. (2020) The Cities of Forking Streets: Trajectories of Urban Conflicts in Russia. *The Journal of Social Policy Studies*, Vol. 19, Issue 2: 189-204. (in Russian)
- [12] Minaeva E., Semenov A. (2020) Policy Transfer in Urban Governance: The Case of Strategic Urban Planning in Russia. *Ars Administrandi*, Vol. 1: 120-136. (in Russian)
- [13] Minaeva E., Panov. P. (2017) Ethnic Regional Autonomies: Variation of the Correlation Between Sub-State Boundaries and Ethnic Groups’ Settlements. *Political Science*, Vol. 4: 178-205. (in Russian)
- [14] Minaeva E. (2016) Urban Settlement Versus Municipal District» in the Context of Vertical Power Structure: Polycentricity in Local Polity. *Bulletin of Perm University. Political Science*, Vol. 1: 83-96. (in Russian)

#### WORKING PAPERS *Solo-authored*

- [1] Minaeva E. Citizens’ Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia. *Under review in Post-Soviet Affairs*.
- [2] Minaeva E. Why Autocrats (De)centralize Electoral Authority: Explaining the Introduction and Cancellation of Subnational Elections.

#### *Co-authored*

- [3] Minaeva E., Melnikov K., Hazell T. Local Elections and Elite Management in Authoritarian Regimes: Evidence from Kazakhstan.
- [4] Minaeva E., Melnikov K., Hazell T. The Governance Effects of Local Elections in Autocracies: Evidence from a Natural Experiment in Kazakhstan.

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| ONLINE PUBLICATIONS                  | <p>[1] Rogov K., &amp; Minaeva E. (2022) The Journey from 1945 to 1941 <a href="#">[Link]</a></p> <p>[2] Minaeva E. (2018) GIS Technologies in Ethno-Political Studies: Spatial Localization of Ethnic Groups <a href="#">[Link]</a></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                          |
| RESEARCH PROJECTS AND COLLABORATIONS | <p><b>Maidan Revolutions, the War in Ukraine, and Civil Society Responses</b> <a href="#">[Project link]</a></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Design and implementation of cross-national survey research in <b>Armenia, Belarus, Russia, and Ukraine</b>, including questionnaire development, coordination with survey firms, and data analysis.</li> </ul> <p><b>GLOBAL — European Governance and Politics Programme (ERC Advanced Grant)</b> <a href="#">[Project link]</a></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Data collection and validation on transnational party networks; development of datasets for evaluating large language models (LLMs).</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                              |                                                          |
| TEACHING EXPERIENCE                  | <p><b>Instructor</b>, TU Darmstadt, Darmstadt, Germany</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Political Paths of Post-Soviet Countries (MA level, block seminar)</li> </ul> <p><b>Instructor</b>, European University Institute, Florence, Italy</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Introduction to R (PhD level)</li> </ul> <p><b>Teaching Assistant</b>, Perm State University, Perm, Russia</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Comparative Politics</li> <li>• Methodology of Political Science</li> <li>• R Programming</li> <li>• Regional Studies</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <p>Fall 2024; Fall 2025</p> <p>2023</p> <p>2020–2022</p> |
| SKILLS AND LANGUAGES                 | <p><b>Methods:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Causal inference with observational data (panel and cross-sectional)</li> <li>• Quasi-experimental designs (including difference-in-differences)</li> <li>• Survey and vignette experiments; questionnaire design</li> <li>• Multilevel and regression analysis</li> </ul> <p><b>Programming and Tools:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• R&amp;R Studio (Advanced), STATA (Intermediate), Python (Beginner)</li> <li>• L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X (Advanced), ArcGIS/ArcMap (Intermediate)</li> <li>• Large language models (LLMs) for data collection and validation (Intermediate)</li> </ul> <p><b>Languages:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Russian: native</li> <li>• English: advanced</li> <li>• Italian: conversational (A2-B1)</li> </ul> |                                                          |
| ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE      | <p>Researchers' Representative</p> <p>Department of Political and Social Sciences, European University Institute</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2024–2025                                                |

## GRANTS

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| European University Institute — Early Stage Researchers Grant<br><i>Local Elections and Elite Management in Authoritarian Regimes: Evidence from Kazakhstan</i>                                                                                                                                  | 2024–2025 |
| Russian Science Foundation<br>Collective Grant<br><i>Mechanisms of Interests Coordination in the Urban Development Processes</i>                                                                                                                                                                 | 2018–2023 |
| Oxford Russia Fellowship<br>Individual Grant<br><i>Political Consequences of the Implementation of Municipal Heads' Appointments in Russia</i>                                                                                                                                                   | 2020–2021 |
| Russian Foundation for Basic Research<br>Collective Grant<br><i>Spatial Localization of Ethnic Minorities within the Framework of Political-Administrative Boundaries as a Factor of Politicization of Ethnicity on Sub-National Level: Russian Practices in the Context of World Experience</i> | 2019–2021 |
| Volkswagen Foundation<br>Collective Grant for Interdisciplinary and International Research<br><i>Shifting Paradigms: Towards Participatory and Effective Urban Planning in Germany, Russia and Ukraine</i>                                                                                       | 2019–2021 |
| Russian Science Foundation<br>Collective Grant for Russian Scholars<br><i>Securing a Balance in Interethnic Relations: Regional autonomies, the State Integrity and the Rights of Ethnic Minorities</i>                                                                                          | 2015–2017 |

## LATEST CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOP TALKS

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| European Political Science Society Conference, June 17-20, 2026<br>Paper: <i>Citizens' Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia</i>                                             |  |
| Political Behaviour Colloquium, March 10, 2026<br>Paper: <i>Citizens' Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia</i>                                                              |  |
| MPSA, Politics and Political Economy of Eurasia Workshop, April 23-26, 2025, Chicago<br>Paper: <i>Local Elections and Elite Management: Evidence from Kazakhstan, co-authored with Kirill Melnikov and Thomas Hazell</i>     |  |
| The Russia Program Annual Conference, April 18, 2025, Washington DC<br>Paper: <i>Russian Centralization in the Global Authoritarian Context</i>                                                                              |  |
| Pre-EPISA Conference on Authoritarian Politics, July 3, 2024, Cologne<br>Paper: <i>Legitimacy Erosion and State Capacity: Explaining Political (De)Centralization in Dictatorships</i>                                       |  |
| Building Closed Autocracies: the Cases of Russia and Belarus, October 6-7, 2022, Berlin<br>Paper: <i>Non-Programmatic Electoral Mobilization of Ethnic Minorities: Evidence from Russia</i>                                  |  |
| 5th Annual Tartu Conference on Russian and East European Studies, June 6-8, 2021<br>Paper: <i>From Elections to Appointments: Does Centralization Strengthen Political Support? Evidence from the Russian Municipalities</i> |  |
| ASN Annual World Convention, May 6-8, 2021<br>Paper: <i>Political Consequences of the Implementation of Municipal Heads' Appointments in Russia</i>                                                                          |  |